

Relocation Risk Assessment

Relocation Complexity Score

Employee: Jane Doe | Egypt -> Switzerland | 28 August 2026

78

out of 100

High-Touch Program

Full Re-Rooted® program with ongoing support. Review timeline and expectations before start date.

KEY RISK AREAS

Values and Working Norms

What counts as direct, respectful or professional differs between the two countries, so intent is misread on both sides during the first months.

Recommended action: Brief the receiving team on the employee's home working norms and give the employee a named cultural sounding board in the local business.

Cultural Adaptation

Daily life friction outside work consumes energy that would otherwise go into ramp-up, extending time to full productivity.

Recommended action: Fund practical settling support (housing, admin, banking, schooling) and set an explicit ramp-up curve rather than day-one full performance expectations.

Wellbeing and Sustained Capacity

Relocation strain is the most common driver of early assignment failure and unplanned return, usually surfacing between months three and nine.

Recommended action: Schedule check-ins at 30, 90 and 180 days with someone outside the reporting line, and make confidential coaching or EAP access explicit.

Language Capability

Limited local language reduces informal information flow, weakens stakeholder relationships and can isolate the employee from decisions made outside formal meetings.

Recommended action: Budget structured language training from month one and confirm which meetings and documents will be run in a shared working language.

Social Integration

Without a network outside work, retention depends entirely on the role going well. If the role wobbles, there is nothing holding the employee in country.

Recommended action: Connect the employee to internal networks and local communities early, and support partner or family integration alongside the employee.

Family and Partner Impact

Accompanying family dissatisfaction, especially partner career disruption, is a leading cause of early return regardless of how well the role is going.

Recommended action: Include partner career support, spousal work permit advice and family integration in the package, and check in with the family, not only the employee.

Children and Schooling

Schooling placement, language of instruction and children settling are common triggers for renegotiating or ending an assignment mid-term.

Recommended action: Confirm school placement and cost coverage before the start date and allow flexibility in the first term for family transition.

COMPLEXITY BY CATEGORY



Assignment Context

45 / 60

What type of assignment is this?

Commuter arrangement (split between countries)

What changes come with this role?

Location change only, same role, same function

Different market, region, or business unit

What is the strategic impact of this assignment?

Business critical, transformation mandate, senior leadership scrutiny from day one

What is the position context?

Newly created position, no predecessor, building from scratch

How much time pressure exists to deliver results?

Immediate, crisis response or urgent business need

How complex is the reporting structure?

Complex matrix, multiple stakeholders across time zones

Cultural Distance

29 / 30

How culturally distant is the host country from home?

Fundamentally different, deeply different worldview, daily life requires major behavioral change

In the host country, how easy is it to find food, products, and routines from home?

Virtually unavailable, will need to fully adapt to local alternatives

How different is the safety, healthcare, and infrastructure environment?

Significant concerns requiring active management

Professional Environment

28 / 30

What is the team dynamic at the destination?

Building a new team from scratch

How different is the work culture?

Fundamentally different, requires rethinking how they operate and lead

How aligned is the local office with HQ culture and expectations?

Resistant local environment, HQ directives met with friction

Language

19 / 20

How well do they speak the host country's primary language?

No proficiency at all

What language is used in the workplace?

Predominantly a language they don't speak well

Family & Accompanying

40 / 50

Who is making this move?

Relocating alone, partner and/or family staying in home country

Ages of children relocating?

Infant or toddler (under 3)

Pre-school (3-5)

What is the impact on the partner's career?

Partner unable to work (no work permit or limited opportunities)

Answer Breakdown (continued)

How does the partner feel about the move?

Strongly opposed or has significant concerns

Are there elderly or dependent family members being left behind?

Primary caregiver responsibilities being handed off to others

Geographic Factors

27 / 30

What is the time zone difference between home/HQ and host country?

9+ hours

How easy is it to travel home?

12+ hours or complex multi-leg journey

How different is the climate and physical environment?

Extreme, requires major adaptation (heat, altitude, humidity, reversed seasons)

Social Readiness

18 / 20

Do they have an existing social network in the host country?

Nobody at all

How established is the expat community in the destination?

Very isolated, few expats, limited social infrastructure

Resilience & Adaptability

36 / 40

How much prior international relocation experience do they have?

First time living outside their home country

How comfortable are they with ambiguity and uncertainty?

Finds uncertainty very stressful and destabilizing

How do they typically respond to major life changes?

Change is very difficult and disruptive

How have they historically experienced homesickness or being away from home?

Intense and prolonged, significantly affects wellbeing